

ALEX CINISI PHOTOGRAPHY · SICILY & WORLDWIDE

THE SICILY WEDDING GUIDE

TWELVE VENUES · FOUR SEASONS · ONE ISLAND



Your love story, told like a film you'll never forget.

FEATURED IN VOGUE ITALIA · MARIE CLAIRE · L'OFFICIEL



note before you begin

I was born in Sicily. I've spent my life watching how the light moves here — how it turns golden and heavy in September, how it softens behind the almond blossom in March, how it lingers on baroque stone long after the sun has gone.

For years I've photographed weddings on this island for couples from London, Munich, Zurich, New York — couples who chose Sicily not as a backdrop, but as a place with a soul.

This guide is what I wish every couple knew before they started planning. It opens with five places I know intimately — venues I've photographed, whose light I've learned by heart. It continues with an edit of seven more that belong on any serious shortlist. Not a brochure. Not a checklist. An honest look at the island, from someone who doesn't fly in for the weekend.

Take your time with it. And when you're ready to talk, I'm one message away.

— *Alex*



N°1

PALERMO · SEAFRONT

Villa Igiea

A Belle Époque grande dame on the edge of Palermo's harbour, restored to something quietly extraordinary. Frescoed salons open onto terraced gardens that fall toward the sea — the kind of place that photographs like a memory you haven't had yet.

THE LIGHT *the western terraces at 6 PM in late summer, when the harbour turns to bronze.*



N°2

SCOPELLO • WHERE MOUNTAINS MEET THE SEA

Tonnara di Scopello

A 15th-century tuna fishery turned into one of the most cinematic places on the island. Stone buildings, faraglioni rising from turquoise water, and almost no decoration needed — the place is the decoration.

THE LIGHT *the hour before sunset, when the rocks glow and the water goes still.*



N°3

TRABIA · CASTLE ON THE WATER

Castello di Trabia

A thousand years of history standing directly over the sea, just east of Palermo. Terraces suspended above the water, gardens that end where the Tyrrhenian begins — grandeur with the sea itself as a witness.

THE LIGHT *the sea terraces at dusk, when the water turns to copper.*



N°4

TAORMINA · GARDEN VILLA

Villa Mon Repos

A patrician villa in the heart of Taormina, its terraced gardens looking out toward the bay. Quieter than the town's grand hotels — a private world minutes from Corso Umberto, made for intimate ceremonies.

THE LIGHT *late afternoon on the garden terraces, the Ionian glittering below.*



N°5

NOTO COUNTRYSIDE · RESTORED ESTATE

Dimora delle Balze

A 19th-century estate in the Noto countryside, restored with an editor's eye — raw stone, contemporary design, courtyards made for long tables and longer evenings. I photographed here recently, and the place stays with you: every wall is a backdrop, every hour a different picture.

THE LIGHT *the inner courtyard at dusk, when the stone holds the warmth of the day.*

Seven more for the shortlist

Venues that belong in the conversation — east, south, and the baroque towns.

06

San Domenico Palace

TAORMINA · CLIFFTOP CONVENT

A 14th-century convent suspended between Etna and the sea — cloistered gardens, long stone corridors, and that Taormina view. For couples who want gravitas: history you can feel underfoot.

The light: golden hour from the terrace, Etna turning violet in the distance.

07

Braccialieri

NOTO · OLIVE ESTATE & DESIGN RETREAT

A 19th-century olive estate just outside Noto, reimagined with wit and colour — centuries-old olive groves, white stone, and the now-iconic chequered pool. Sicilian tradition with a designer's eye, made for celebrations that feel like the best house party of your life.

The light: the last hour among the olive trees, when everything turns cinematic.

08

La Camparia

MARZAMEMI · HISTORIC TONNARA

The old heart of Marzamemi's tonnara, where fishermen once kept their boats and nets — now one of the most atmospheric spaces on the south-east coast. Sea at the doorstep, salt in the stone, a fishing village turned stage.

The light: blue hour on the piazza, when the village lights come on and the sea goes dark.

09

Castello Xirumi

SIRACUSA COUNTRYSIDE · FORTIFIED ESTATE

A fortified estate among citrus groves, halfway between Siracusa and the baroque towns. Generous, warm, quietly grand — where a wedding becomes a two-day gathering rather than a single event.

The light: long shadows across the courtyard in the last hour of sun.

South & west

Where the island keeps its secrets — and its longest sunsets.

10

Castello di Falconara

BUTERA · CASTLE ON THE BEACH

A medieval castle standing directly on a wild stretch of southern coast. Rare, romantic, slightly surreal — a castle with sand at its feet, for couples who want drama without formality.

The light: sunset here is the longest on the island — the south coast keeps it minutes more.

11

Baglio Oneto

MARSALA · VINEYARDS & SUNSET COAST

A historic baglio above the Marsala coastline, surrounded by vineyards, facing the Egadi islands. The west is Sicily's best-kept secret — fewer crowds, softer pace, longer evenings.

The light: aperitivo hour on the terrace, islands dissolving into the horizon.

12

Commenda di San Calogero

SOUTH-EAST COAST · SEASIDE ESTATE

An aristocratic estate where gardens run almost to the water. Intimate, green, unhurried — a place that rewards couples who plan around slow afternoons rather than tight schedules.

The light: filtered light through the garden pines, all afternoon long.

Choosing between them? That's a conversation I'd love to have — the answer depends on your season, your guests, and your light.

The four seasons of a Sicilian wedding

Spring

MARCH — MAY

Sicily wakes up early. By March the almond trees have blossomed and the hills are impossibly green — a Sicily most visitors never see. Gentle temperatures, quieter venues, light that stays soft all day. Best for garden ceremonies and couples who want the island lush and unhurried.

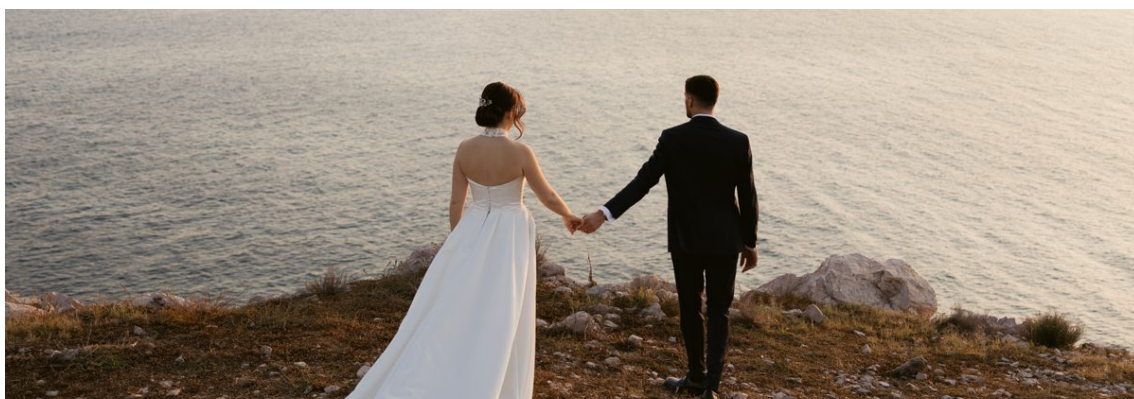
The light: forgiving from morning to dusk — the most underrated season to marry in.

Summer

JUNE — AUGUST

The Sicily of the imagination: sea like glass, long dinners outdoors, nights that never quite cool down. The boldest choice — the day is built around the heat: late ceremony, golden-hour portraits, dancing under the stars. Midday is for shade and spritz, not ceremonies.

The light: harsh at noon, extraordinary at 7 PM. Timing is everything — and timing is my job.



Autumn & winter

Autumn

SEPTEMBER — OCTOBER

If Sicilian light has a peak, it's now. September keeps summer's warmth without its weight; October brings the harvest, the vineyards turning, a kind of amber stillness. The season most of my international couples choose — and the one I'd choose myself. September dates go first: 12 to 18 months ahead is normal.

The light: heavy, golden, cinematic. The season film was made for.

Winter

NOVEMBER — FEBRUARY

Winter Sicily is for the few: baroque interiors by candlelight, empty piazzas, a table for thirty instead of two hundred. Elopements and intimate weddings belong to this season — there's a privacy to the island now that money can't buy in July. The island is yours; so are the best venues, at their calmest.

The light: low, raking, dramatic — winter light makes interiors sing.

Whatever season you choose, there is a light on this island waiting for it.

THE APPROACH

What “editorial” means — and what it doesn't

01 Invisible presence

My approach is quiet, intuitive, human. You live your day — I capture it unfolding naturally. Most couples tell me afterwards they barely noticed the camera. That's the point.

02 Editorial sensibility

No stiff poses. No awkward “say cheese.” When direction is needed, it's subtle — a place to stand, a light to walk toward. The rest is you.

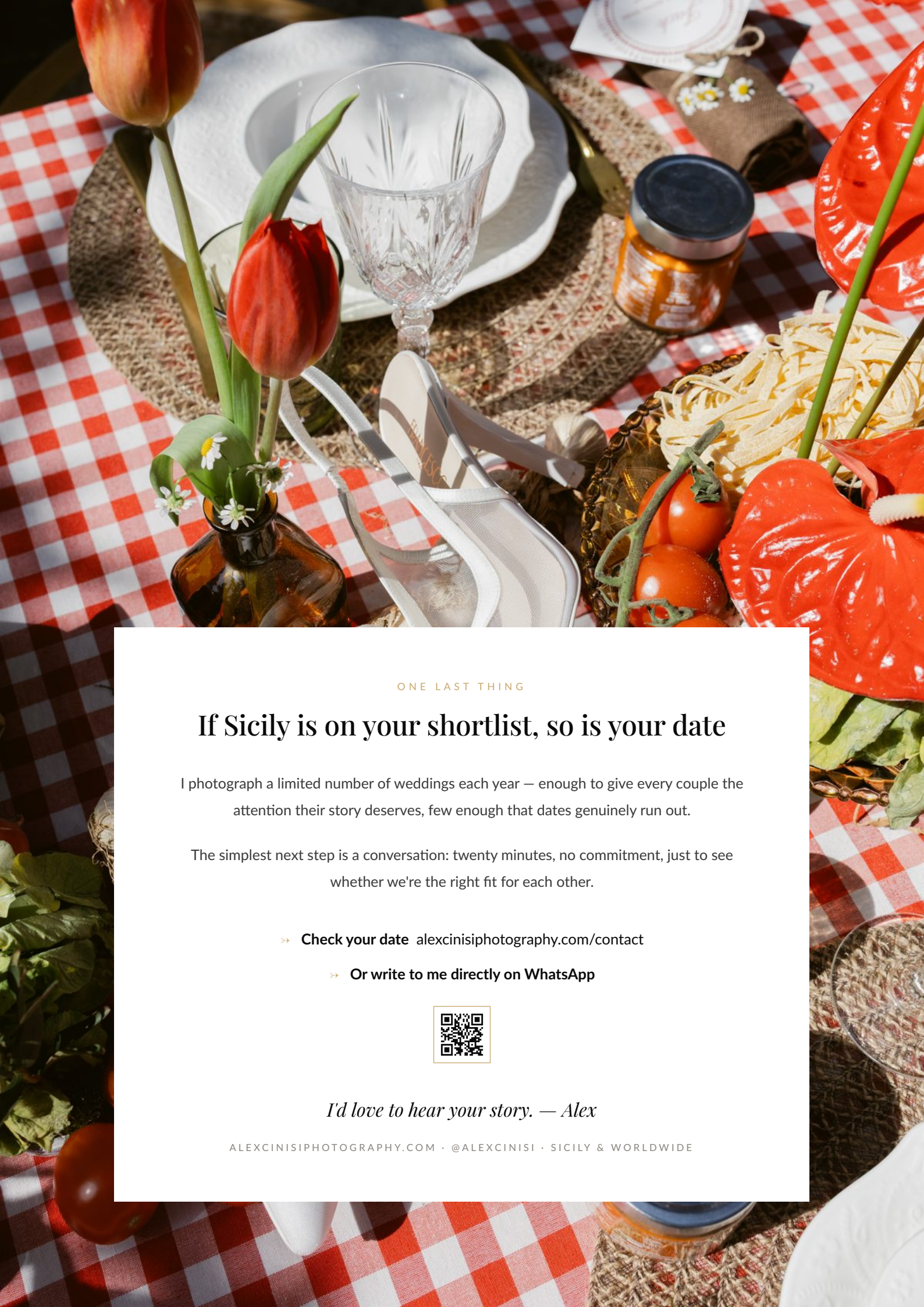
03 Bespoke attention

I take on a limited number of weddings each year, and two photographers come with every one of them. I shoot film alongside digital — film for the images that deserve to feel like heirlooms, digital for the moments that won't wait. And everything happens in English, from our first conversation to your final gallery.

*“Twenty unhurried minutes at golden hour
are worth two staged hours at noon.”*

SELECTED WORK FEATURED IN

VOGUE ITALIA · MARIE CLAIRE · L'OFFICIEL · LA CUCINA ITALIANA



ONE LAST THING

If Sicily is on your shortlist, so is your date

I photograph a limited number of weddings each year — enough to give every couple the attention their story deserves, few enough that dates genuinely run out.

The simplest next step is a conversation: twenty minutes, no commitment, just to see whether we're the right fit for each other.

» **Check your date** alexcinisiphotography.com/contact

» **Or write to me directly on WhatsApp**



I'd love to hear your story. — Alex

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